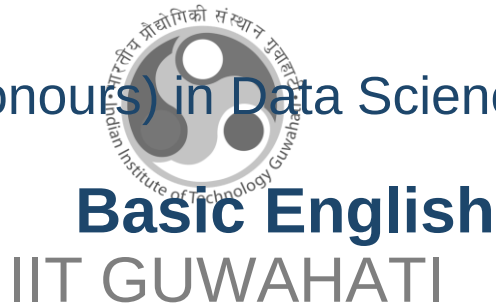


Bachelor of Science (Honours) in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence





Module Name: Listening

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Learning Objectives

- 01 Familiarise the students with listening skills
- 02 introduce the students to various listening strategies
- 03 Help students understand the barriers to listening
- 04 Understand how to get over the problems in listening
- 05 Discuss the types of listening and their contexts

listening skills

What does effective listening involve?

Why is it called a skill?

When we achieve a very good level of listening in a particular language, we often forget how sophisticated this skill really is! The terms we use to describe the processes of listening are called sub- skills and they include:



Listening sub skills

Predicting	Thinking about what you are going to hear, based on what you know about the speaker, the topic and the context	Your friend sends you a video from social media of an interview with an actor you both like. What will you think?
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Listening sub skills

Listening for gist DO NOT COPY	Understanding just the general topic of what you hear IIT GUWAHATI	You are walking in a park and you overhear friends talking. One of them is talking about a recent family event. Are all the details necessary?
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Listening sub skills

Listening for key information	Identifying specific words or phrases in what you hear	You are waiting at the train station, listening to the announcement with information about which platform to go to. What will you pay attention to?
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Listening sub skills

Listening for detailed understanding	Understanding the content of what you hear in depth, especially the opinions and attitudes of the speaker(s)	You want to go to the cinema with your friends. Your friends' opinion matter.
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Effective listening:

Expert listeners can bring these four sub-skills together when they listen. For example, we recognise the word Unbelievable! Our ability to match the sounds to the word is called bottom-up processing. But the word unbelievable doesn't tell us much about the person's recent experience.

Why were they so shocked? How did they feel? Angry? Amused? Disappointed?

Listen for more information, we need to know the context and co-text. This is called top-down processing.

Top down processing

Process	Definition	Everyday life situation
Bottom-up processing = recognising what you hear	Recognising small units (sounds), building them up into bigger units (words) and then bigger ones (phrases). Sometimes called 'decoding	You ask someone for an address and they tell you it's number 60. You accurately identify the sounds and stress of the word sixty and don't mishear it as sixteen.

Top-down processing

Process	Definition	Everyday life situation
Top-down processing = understanding what it means	Using context (knowledge of the world) and co-text (what the speaker has said so far) to help you understand words that are not clear	You're watching a fashion programme on TV. You think you hear someone talking about string, summer, autumn and winter. You doubt that you heard the first word correctly – you know that spring is a word. You make an informed guess!

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Effective Listening Strategies

Listening is a skill that can be practised and learned. Your goal as a listener is to fully understand the other party's experience and point of view. Give the other party an opportunity to talk for a while before saying anything.

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Improving listening: strategies

Strategy	Practical Application
Use non-verbal communication	● Be aware of what you communicate with your body - your posture and expressions can convey your attitudes ● Use body language

Strategy: Recognize your own prejudices

Practical Application

- Be aware of your feelings toward the speaker
- If you are unsure about what the speaker means, ask for clarification instead of making assumptions

Improving listening: strategies

Strategy	Practical Application
Listen to understand the underlying feelings	• Use your heart as well as your mind to understand the speaker • Notice how something is said as well as the actual words used

Strategy: Do not interrupt

Practical Application

- Be sure to think carefully before you speak
- As a listener, your job is to help the speaker express themselves

Improving listening: strategies

Strategy	Practical Application
Do not judge the person	• A speaker who feels you are making judgments will feel defensive • Avoid making judgments and instead try to empathize and understand the speaker's perspective

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Do not give advice

- Keep in mind that the best resolutions are those that people arrive at themselves, not what someone else tells them to do
- If you feel it is appropriate, and only after you have encouraged the person to talk, offer some ideas and discuss them

Improving listening: strategies

Strategy	Practical Application
Use non-verbal communication	• Be aware of what you communicate with your body - your posture and expressions can convey your attitudes • Use body language to show the speaker that you are engaged in the conversation and open to hearing (e.g., face the speaker; make eye contact)

Recognize your own prejudices

- Be aware of your feelings toward the speaker
- If you are unsure about what the speaker means, ask for clarification instead of making assumptions



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Types of Listening



TYPES OF LISTENING

1. Superficial listening
2. Appreciative listening
3. Focused listening
4. Evaluative listening
5. Attentive listening
6. Empathetic listening

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Types of Listening



Types

Superficial listening
content of the verbal message.

Appreciative listening
pleasure.

Focused listening
information.

Characteristics

The listener has little awareness of the

The purpose of listening is to derive

The purpose is to get some specific

Types of Listening



Types

Evaluative listening

evaluate the oral message, commentary and develop a line of thought.

Attentive listening

productive, facilitating proper interaction and more effective listener-speaker relationships.

Empathetic listening

speaker's feelings, emotions, and state of mind.

Characteristics

The purpose is to

It Is interactive and

more effective

It involves listening to the

state of mind.



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Types of Listening



Superficial Listening

In this type of listening, the listener has little awareness of the content (what is being said). The output in this type of listening is zero because the listener tends to ignore the message, and is not able to concentrate on the theme, main points, and supporting details of the message.

Types of Listening



Appreciative Listening

The main purpose of appreciative listening is to get enjoyment and pleasure. Examples include listening to recordings of songs, entertaining stories, jokes, anecdotes, and so on. The output may be taking part in the entertainment process. For example, a music lover may listen to the latest hit, pick up the chorus and tune, and try to sing along.

Types of Listening



Focused Listening

Focused listening involves listening for specific information. The main purpose is to get some specific information that might be used to take a decision. This is the most common type of listening that we practice in non-formal oral communicative situations. Examples include listening to the radio, watching and listening to television programmes, listening to railway and airport announcements, and so on.

Types of Listening



Evaluative Listening

Evaluative listening involves evaluation of the oral message or commentary. The listener interprets and analyses what he or she listens to.

It may also involve matching topics against one's own interests, and making mental notes of the important points.

Thus, the main purpose of evaluative listening is to evaluate the content of the oral message to select appropriate information.

Types of Listening



Attentive Listening

Attentive listening demands the complete attention of the listener. It is basically active and intelligent listening in situations such as group discussions, meetings, job interviews, and so on. The listener pays attention to all parts of the message,

There is no 'selective dismissal' of any part of the oral message.

As attentive listening is interactive and productive - facilitating proper interaction and more effective listener-speaker relationships.

It requires conscious effort

Types of Listening



Empathetic listening is listening not only to what the speaker is saying but also to how he/she is saying, i.e., his/her feelings, emotions, and state of mind.

The listener has to understand and respond to the affective signals

Be alert to the speaker's implied meaning, intention, and attitude,

Has to understand and interpret non-verbal clues and the body language. of the speaker.



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The anatomy of poor listening

Why is it that our listening is not as good as it ought to be?

Our brain is capable of processing 500 to 750 words a minute while people only speak 120 to 150 words a minute.

Does dissipation of attention, lead to poor listening?

The anatomy of poor listening

If our listening is poor we **do** think of things other than what the speaker is telling us.

The explanation that we use the brain's spare capacity to think of other things.

Face-to-face oral communication is a complex and messy affair.

Different researchers estimate the oral component of face-to-face communication to be between 15 and 25 per cent of the total. The rest consists of a wide range of non-verbal symbols

The anatomy of poor listening

Partial and selective listening is, of course, all that is needed in several contexts. you are at a railway station waiting for a friend's train to arrive.

While you are at the station, you hear dozens of announcements about the arrival and departure of trains. What information will you pay attention to?

POOR LISTENING

You filter out as noise **the** information that does **not** interest you.

Superficial listening is more than enough to monitor the announcements.

Our body language changes dramatically when what is relevant to us enters our mind's radar screen. Our listening becomes intense.

The intensity weakens again when we realise that an announcement relevant to us is just a repetition **and** we already know what **the content** is.

If we have a choice, often we choose not to listen.

Has it happened to you?





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There are several factors—linguistic, physical, and psychological—that contribute to poor listening and grossly inadequate reconstruction of the speaker's meaning. Here are a few

Inadequate Language

Poor listening may stem from the listener's weak language proficiency in

Certain words a speaker uses may not make any sense to a listener
When **a listener** thinks he knows the meaning of a word, he may not ask for clarification.

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Difficult Physical Conditions

Poor listening can stem from difficult conditions in which one has to listen.

Or he may give **up mentally** while pretending to **be** listening, This is especially true when the speaker is of an intimidatingly high status.

Non-serious listening

Some listeners **allow** themselves to be distracted.

Active courting of distractions- The temptation to combine listening with other activities is particularly strong when people speak on the phone.

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Antipathy To Speaker

It consists of the listener's psychological barriers.

Dislike or disapproval of a speaker.

The dislike of appearance or mannerisms.

or deep-seated prejudices of their socio-economic background, their profession, their religion, race or their political affiliation.

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Over-enthusiasm for Speaker or discriminatory listening

If we like a person very much or are very enthusiastic about her, we may listen to her uncritically.

When people we don't approve of argue vehemently, we judge that they are unreasonable.

When people we like argue in a similar way, we feel that they are passionately committed to an ideology and are right in firmly supporting it.

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Lack of Confidence

If we decide in advance that we will not be able to make sense of what the other person is going to say, our listening suffers.

This is particularly common in classrooms where complex issues are discussed or concepts explained.

Some students start with the assumption that they will not be able to cope. And they fulfil their prophecy. They are being unfair to themselves and the speakers.

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Impatience

- Impatience is born out of overconfidence.
- Before they hear out the speaker some listeners assume that they know what is coming. They find the speaker too slow. They can't wait for the speaker to finish.
- This tendency of the listener to jump the gun annoys most speakers. To plan one's response while pretending to be listening.

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Strong Convictions

The mind, says a wit, is like a parachute. It works only when it is open.

The trouble is our minds are often closed. We are so sure of certain things that we don't see the need to reconsider them.

You may think I am listening; I am not. You are mistaken. I haven't been listening. I have been faking it.

Disagreeing or presenting a different perspective might lead to either waste of time or unpleasantness.

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Strong convictions and preconceived notions based on our prior experience can be an invisible barrier to listening.

Strong disagreements generally bring out the worst types of listening in us.

It is not at all uncommon to see two people speaking to each other simultaneously.

The arguments get heated. If one withdraws after a while, it is because he feels that the other is so irrational there is no point in continuing the argument.



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The anatomy of poor speaking

Poor speakers are primarily poor listeners.

Poor managers, poor negotiators, poor interviewers, and poor teachers are almost invariably poor listeners, and as a result, poor speakers.

Poor speaking manifests itself in some of the following ways:

Little or No Planning

Planning is needed to ensure success.

The depth of planning will vary depending on the type of challenge involved.

The anatomy of poor speaking



Strategise - The speaker should have a good idea of what answers he would get to questions such as the following:

What kind of person is my listener?

How much does she know of the topic I am going to talk on?

What is her attitude to it? What is (likely to be) her attitude towards me?

How sensitive is she in general and in particular to the topic I want to talk about?

Is my objective of talking to her reasonable ?

What might prompt her to support my position?

The anatomy of poor speaking



Insensitivity to the listener and the Context

Speaking to another person requires deft moves and countermoves.

It is a delicate balancing act.

Absence of empathy makes the speaker miss several symbols displayed by the listener.

. **In** extreme cases of apathy and antipathy the speaker may not even suspect that something is amiss.

Being unaware of it or ignoring it willfully also may result in poor communication.

The anatomy of poor speaking



There is a saying that even God cannot approach a hungry man except in the form of bread.

This is the essence of empathy.

The speaker has to be sensitive to the needs, concerns, and aspirations of the listener.

Successful peacemakers and successful persuaders accurately identify what touches the hearts of the buyers of goods, services, and ideas.

The anatomy of poor speaking



Use of Inappropriate Verbal Symbols

Words, we have seen, play only a small role in face-to-face communication;

But just as the tiny flame from a small matchstick can start a major fire, an ill-chosen word can cause a major disaster in human relations.

Words can hide meaning; words can bare meaning. Words can hurt; words can heal. Choice of words may, therefore, be critical especially because words are definable and recordable.

The anatomy of poor speaking



Know the listener's vocabulary to **be effective**.

Listeners may not share her linguistic, social, political or professional background of the speaker.

Slang, jargon, acronyms, and obscure idioms fall in this category.

Some speakers are so lazy that they use very vague expressions where precise ones are called for.

As the cat tells Alice in Lewis Carroll's *Alice in Wonderland*, if you are not particular where you want to get, it doesn't matter which way you go. Pace of speech is another factor that a speaker ought to monitor.



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Listening comprehension

Comprehension is the act of understanding or the power of the mind to understand

Listening comprehension is the act of understanding an oral message.

As a professional, you have to achieve the ability to comprehend material delivered at relatively fast speed and understand spoken material in standard Indian English, British English or American English.

You need intelligent listening skills in all formal situations

Listening comprehension

Listening is a complex process that involves perceiving and interpreting the sounds correctly a understanding the explicit and implied meaning of the oral message, These skills include scanning, prediction, speech decoding, comprehending, and oral discourse analysis.

Scanning is the ability to locate specific information in a conversation, speech, or presentation whereas prediction is guessing information. The three other skills need some explanation.

Listening comprehension

Speech Decoding

Speech decoding is integral to listening comprehension. It involves sound perception and recognition, word recognition, and accent recognition,

Sound Perception and Recognition

Decoding of verbal messages requires the ability to perceive and recognise speech sounds and sound patterns accurately.

The listener has to be attentive to the sounds that he/she hears because any lapse or mistake may lead to miscommunication.

Listening Comprehension

Word Recognition

Speech decoding during listening also involves the ability to recognise words accurately, recognise the way words are used in context, and identify discourse markers.

Accent Recognition

In order to decode a verbal message, the listener has to recognise stress and intonation patterns. In addition, he/she needs to identify pauses, false starts, hesitations, and turn-taking in a conversation.

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Listening Comprehension

Comprehending

Comprehending a verbal message involves the ability to:

- identify the central theme, main ideas, and supporting details
- Concentrate and understand long speeches
- Identify the level of formality
- Deduce incomplete information
- Decode unfamiliar vocabulary

Listening Comprehension

Oral Discourse Analysis

Oral discourse analysis is the process of identifying relationships among different units within the speech or oral message. It includes critical skills, attitude analysis, and inferential skills.

Critical Skills

When you listen to a structured talk, speech, or presentation, you need to analyse it in order to distinguish between relevant and irrelevant information, factual and nonfactual information, examples and ideas, and so on. Critical skills are, thus, essential to effective listening comprehension.

Listening Comprehension

Attitude Analysis

You may have to analyse a verbal message in order to understand the speaker's attitude. This is more important in meetings, discussions, and conferences. Attitude analysis includes the following skills:

- Identifying a speaker's attitude
- Understanding the speaker's attitude
- Evaluating a speaker's attitude

Listening Comprehension

Inferential Skills

Effective listening comprehension involves understanding not only the explicit meaning of a verbal message but also the implicit meaning because the speaker may not speak everything explicitly and clearly.

Thus, the listener may have to analyse a verbal message in order to draw inferences and conclusions. This may involve interpreting the non-verbal clues and body language of the speaker.

Listening Comprehension



Examples of Closed Questions

1. is this deal acceptable to the management?
2. Are we facing this problem for the first time?
3. Will you accept this proposal?

Listening Comprehension

While asking questions, the listener should not argue or be rigid on a question. Here are some tips on how to ask questions – Questions should be asked at the appropriate points. The speaker should not be interrupted. Questions should be chosen carefully, The purpose of asking a question should be to get clarifications and indicate comprehension. Simple language should be used to phrase questions. Questions should be asked one at a time The listener should wait for an answer patiently. The listener should listen carefully to the answer and not jump to conclusions.

Listening Comprehension



Clarifying

Clarify what the speaker is saying by paraphrasing what has been said or summarising one's understanding of the key points.

This way the listener can show that he/she is listening carefully and paying attention.

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Listening Comprehension

Analysing

As an active listener, one should interpret and analyse what one hears in order to:

Understand both explicit as well as implicit meaning of an oral message

- Differentiate between ideas, opinions, feelings, and facts, as expressed by the speaker
- Infer the meaning of unfamiliar words from contextual or internal clues
- Draw inferences and conclusions from the speech

Listening Comprehension



Listening in Conversational Interaction

We may have to listen during two-way interactions that may include informal conversations, academic interactions, student-teacher consultations, student-student negotiation, job interviews, and so on.

Listening plays a key role in these communicative situations as the output of listening in all these situations is to make considered oral responses.

Listening Comprehension

The following suggestions can help improve listening effectiveness during face-to-face conversational interactions:

Listen for Conversational Signals

During a conversation, every participant has to take his/her turn at the appropriate moment.

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Each participant has to look out for conversational signals indicating the possibility of starting his/her turn so that he/she is able to take a turn at the appropriate moment.

Listening Comprehension



Evaluate

While listening to professional and administrative requirements involving requests, suggestions, or instructions, the listener should evaluate what he/she listens to in order to develop a line of thought. He/she has to determine necessary action as the output is to perform some physical activity, make an oral response, impart or solicit information, and so on.

Be Careful While Labelling

Forming impressions about him/her.

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Listening Comprehension



Use Attention Signals

These attention signals could be receptive expressions and utterances such as 'oh yes', 'yes', 'fine', 'of course', 'well', 'ok', 'that's fine', 'no problem', 'really', 'oh no', or just informal grunts such as 'uhuh's', 'mm's', '*un-hum', and so forth.

Work Hard at Listening IIT GUWAHATI

Most of us are really not good listeners. Thus, we have to work hard to become good listeners.

Listening Comprehension

Adjust Your Pace of Listening

As mentioned before, the speed at which we listen is faster than the speed at which we can speak.

This time lag may prove boring and lead to a lack of concentration, which may result in poor listening comprehension.

So, we should adjust our pace of listening by reviewing what the speaker is saying during this lag time.



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Listening to Structured Talks

In order to understand a structured talk (i.e., lectures, seminar talks, presentations, speeches, oral reports, and so on) or any other formal oral discourse, we require effective listening strategies that help us in comprehending the subject-content and language patterns of the oral message. These techniques include pre-listening analysis, predicting, use of background knowledge, intensive listening, and ability to understand the links between different parts of speech. In order to become an effective listener, we need to learn and polish these listening techniques.

Listening to Structured Talks

Pre-listening Analysis

Pre-listening analysis includes determining the purpose of listening and knowing the speaker or presenter.

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Listening to Structured Talks

Determining the Purpose

Does the listener want to listen to the speaker to get a broad understanding of a topic of his/her interest? Does he/she intend to obtain specific information? Does he/she want to be aware of the opinions and reactions of the speaker to a specific situation or problem?

Does he/she want to understand specific instructions? Whether his/her purpose is to get facts or opinions, understand attitude or perspective, he/she must have a clear idea of what he/she wants to remember at the end of the conversation/talk/lecture/speech/presentation/seminar/workshop.

Listening to Structured Talks

Knowing Your Speaker

The second essential aspect in pre-listening analysis is analysing the speaker. If the listener knows the speaker well, he/she will be able to make appropriate adaptations for better understanding. Is the speaker an expert of the subject, or just a generalist? What are his/her background and specific qualifications that make him/her fit for the presentation? Has the listener ever heard him/her before? Answers to these questions will give the listener a fairly good idea of the speaker and help him/her improve.



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The Good Listener

Good listening is active, empathic listening. And that is hard work.

But because it is the cornerstone of all good communication let's take a look at the profile of the good listener.

The good listener has an open mind. But it is not so open that there is no schema or framework to place the ideas she receives from the speaker.

The good listener has a framework to start with. This helps her anticipate the line the speaker is likely to take.

The Good Listener



The good listener actively engages the Ideas the speaker presents

In other words, the good listener is a critical listener.

She sifts the ideas and weighs the evidence as she listens.

She notes everything but accepts and retains only what passes her criteria. She neither accepts nor rejects the ideas uncritically, That active engagement with ideas helps her focus her mind on the task of listening and improve her retention of ideas.

The Good Listener



If the engagement is longer than a few minutes, the good listener also quickly reviews and summarises what she has heard so far.

This reduces the burden on the memory because what she has accepted so far becomes part of a system; it does not remain disparate pieces.

There is, however, a danger in critical listening. Critical listening is essential for good technical communication, Critical listening is called for even in interpersonal communication; but the listener has to be far more accommodative.

The Good Listener



The Good Listener Asks Questions

One way in which an active listener shows engagement is by asking the speaker questions whenever feasible.

questions help the speaker elaborate on underdeveloped ideas or correct certain misconceptions.

Answers to certain other questions will help the listener confirm, reject or revise interim conclusions she may have arrived at.

Body Language



The Good Listener



The Good Listener Listens with Her Whole Body

Good listening is not just an aural activity.

It involves the whole body, And soul, one might add!

If one tries to do unrelated things while listening, the reconstruction of the message is bound to be affected badly.

Moreover, denied continuous feedback, the speaker will not know how to proceed, what to say, what to avoid.

The Good Listener

If there is pleasure on the listener's face, the speaker is encouraged to speak.

Good, animated listeners are in great demand.

They bring out the best in speakers. If you listen with your whole body and soul, you can also resist distractions that distort the message that you are reconstructing.

It is not possible to listen fully and actively if the mind is full of worries and tensions.

The Good Listener



The Good Listener Does Not Judge Prematurely

The good listener resists passing judgement until she has found enough evidence.

Many poor listeners jump to conclusions long before the speaker has completed sending his message. "Sought-after conversationalists listen attentively; only amateurs play the second guessing game."

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The trouble with jumping to conclusions is that it closes the listener's mind. The good listener waits and weighs the evidence gathered. She suspends her judgement until the end.

The Good Listener



The Good Listener Goes Beyond the Message; She Takes Interest in the Message-Sender, too

The good listener builds up a profile of the speaker while recreating his message.

Perhaps a speaker keeps making sweeping and derogatory remarks about everyone else; in his eyes everyone is awful. Perhaps he holds a very low opinion of his company's leadership. Perhaps he is consistently critical of people who belong to a particular region, religion, or political party.

The Good Listener

Perhaps he is a sucker: he believes everything he hears. Perhaps he is hypocritical. Perhaps he is vain. Perhaps he tends to exaggerate everything. Perhaps he has a confused mind. Perhaps he is given to jealousy. Perhaps he is mean-minded. Perhaps he is generous. Perhaps he is very cautious when he speaks. Perhaps he has unusually detailed knowledge about someone, some place, or something.

A listener may build up a tentative profile of the speaker during a single conversation or over a series of interactions.

Such knowledge of the speaker helps a good listener listen critically and build up the right message.

Team Listening

In view of the widespread use of oral communication in team management and decision making, there can be little doubt about the value of good listening skills in achieving group communicative goals.

By participating as an active listener, we may meet a personal need to contribute to the accomplishments of the goals of a group activity.

Moreover, active participation as a listener in a group and its discussions and deliberations serves the group-centered needs of an individual.

Finally, active listening meets the ego-centered needs of listeners by enhancing their status as successful "communicators". Listening in teams is more difficult than listening to structured talks and well-organised lectures.

Improving team listening skills

There are two kinds of distractions that might disrupt the listening process.

The first of these distractions result from surrounding noise and physical disturbances. In order to avoid these external distractions during the process of listening, you have to ensure that all channels are free of noise during the time of communication.

The second type of distractions may result from your disturbed state of mind. The best way to control these distractions is to avoid team listening while you are emotionally disturbed.

Improving team listening skills

However, if you cannot avoid listening, you should focus 100% on what other members of the team are talking about

Using negative non-verbal signals during group communication is not only rude but also against team spirit.

Do not use non-verbal signals to show disagreement, boredom, and lack of comprehension.

It is better to express these feelings verbally. Avoid using fingers or negative head shaking to say 'no', or 'rolling eyes' to indicate that the speaker is a fool, or negative hand gestures to show that you disagree.

Team Listening

Be involved

Be alert and pay close attention while listening to your team members. Make conscious efforts with concentration, involvement and responsibility to improve your listening effectiveness as a team member.

Don't interrupt

It is impolite to interrupt a person who is speaking as it shows lack of respect and creates misunderstanding. It makes you overeager and careless. Good team spirit demands better manners.

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Team Listening

Be Objective

Good team members avoid making subjective observations while listening to each other.

Being objective will help you as well as the team members in getting a clear picture of each other's ideas and feelings.

Also, avoid giving judgements on what you listen. Expressions such as "I think your reasoning is inappropriate", or "I do not understand your attitude" should be avoided.



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LISTENING AND NOTE TAKING

When you are listening to lectures, you take notes for future reference. It is possible that you may go back to your notes the same evening or six months later.

It is important that you should be able to make sense of your notes at any point of time. You should also be able to write a coherent paragraph or essay based on the notes. The chart below summarizes the process.

Listen to lecture → Take notes → Study notes → Write a Text

Listening and Note taking

Taking notes while listening to lectures and talks is an important academic activity.

While reading a text, you can reread several times for better comprehension.

You have to carefully filter the information that you receive.

Note taking includes four simple steps, i.e., listening, filtering, paraphrasing, and noting.

Listening and Note taking



For example, when she says, “let me begin with monarchy, one of the oldest forms of government”. Your notes may read something like this Monarchy-oldest forms of govt.

Avoid expressing the idea in a sentence. Use short forms and abbreviations.

Express the main points and their supporting details in a short or in a condensed manner. Organize the main ideas and supporting details in a systematic way.

You use the first level of numbering such as 1, 2, 3 or et cetera for main ideas and the second level of numbering such as 1.1 and 1.2 or 2.1 and 2.2 for supporting details.

Listening and Note taking

When you listen to academic lecture or talks, it is necessary to take notes for future reference.

For example, she may say, “Today we will discuss five approaches to the philosophy of language”.

By saying this, she signals that she will be discussing five main ideas.

So, the first important step in note is to identify the main ideas and their supporting details.

Listening and Note taking

- Carefully listen to the verbal message in order to identify its purpose and scope.
- Identify different modes and styles of delivery (i.e., reading style, conversational style, informal style, rhetorical style, and so on).

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Listening and Note taking



- Deduce meanings of words and phrases from their context and infer relationships.
- Recognise key terms related to the subject/topic of the lecture.
- Recognise function of stress and intonation to signal information structure.
Recognise function of non-verbal cues as markers of emphasis and attitude.
- Interpret the oral message with reference to oral conventions followed by the speaker.

Listening and Note taking

Filter

- Do not try to write everything. Filter the information received.
- Concentrate on verbal signposts to recognise the organisation and main points in an oral message.

Identify relationships among units within the speech

Look out for key phrases and signal words

Identify the role of discourse markers.

Listening and Note taking

Paraphrase

After identifying the core information, rephrase suitably.

Use appropriate words and phrases to express the central idea, main points, and main supporting details

Do not use full sentences.



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LISTENING TO ANNOUNCEMENTS

We listening for different purpose. Keeping in mind the information we are seeking, we choose to listen to certain details and ignore the rest. Similarly, our eyes look at those things that interest us and ignore the rest. We need to develop the ability to listen selectively.

When you listen to a particular news item that interests you, you may listen for all the details, while on certain occasions, you may listen for some specific information. When you stand at a railway station, bus stations or an airport, you listen to announcements. On such occasions, you listen for specific information. You may want to find out when a bus or a train is expected to arrive or leave or you may want to know which platform the bus or train will arrive on or leave from.

Before you do the task that follow, you should become familiar with the following terms often heard in the announcements at railway stations, bus stations and airport.

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Type of text	Suitable visual
Classificatory (any text that classifies things)	Tree diagram
Descriptive (descriptions of linear processes which take place in a sequential manner)	Flow Chart
Descriptive (descriptions of cyclic processes)	Cyclic Chart
Comparative (texts comparing two or more things)	Table
Statistical Information (information about progress/distribution)	Diagrams (bar, line or pie)

Scheduled time: The time as per the timetable or schedule

Expected arrival time: the time when a train or flight is expected to arrive

Estimated departure time: the time when a flight or train is estimated to leave

On scheduled: at the scheduled time (=no delay)



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All trains, buses and flights have a particular number. Information about tarins is usually given in following manner.

Number

starting point-Destination

Name

7029

Hyderabad-Thiruvananthapuram

Sabari Express



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Unlike trains, flights do not have a name. When a flight is announced, only the flight number, the starting points and the destination are given. The numbers are preceded by a letter code that indicates the name of the airline. Example:

Airline	To	Flight Number	From
IC	Chennai	671	Mumbai
S2	Bangalore	307	Hyderabad

And a different numbering and information for buses, metro and so on

We listen to news on the radio or television to learn about events in different parts of the world. When we listen to a news bulletin, we do not listen to every news item for the full details. The manner in which we listen to a news bulletin is similar to the way in which we read a newspaper. News items are read selectively. For example, you may know the result of the cricket match that way played yesterday. But, you may not know who won the man of the Match award. So you may scan the newspaper or listen to the news bulletin only for that place of information



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Listening for specific information

1. Listen to this news bulletin and identify the correct option.
 - a. Long distance/Local call rates will be reduced minimally/substantially.
 - b. STD rates are expected to fall by 70-80% / 60-70% / 70%
 - c. The new rates have already come into effect/ will be announced in a week/ were announced a week ago.

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Ans- There is good news who use their landlines to make long distance calls. The government proposes to slash the long distance call rates from fixed landline phones drastically, following the recommendations of the Television Regularly Authority of India. Under its single-rate plan for the country, the government proposes to reduce STD rates by 60 to 70%. An announcement to this effect is expected to be made in a week, said a senior government official in New Delhi today.



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English is not only used for professional for academic purposes, but also in day-to-day interactions. You have already learnt that the English use in such situations is more chatty and informal. Short phrases or incomplete sentences are used in such communication.



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